

Organic architecture

With parallels to the Arts and Crafts movement, Frank Lloyd Wright promoted a philosophy of architecture advocating harmony and unity between buildings and the natural world. In an article for *Architectural Record* in 1914 he stated that 'the ideal of an organic architecture ... is a sentient, rational building ... individually fashioned to serve its particular purpose'. And in his 1954 book *The Natural House*, he wrote: 'So here I stand before you ... declaring organic architecture to be the modern ideal.' The concept of an organic style was not unique to Wright, and other architects had their own ideas about it, but he became its best-known proponent. It included the assertion that a site should be enhanced by a building, which should derive its form partly from the nature of the site. The relationship to the site should be unique, such that it would be out of place elsewhere. In natural settings, buildings might open out, and in urban places, turn in. Buildings were to grow out of the landscape as naturally as any plant, while materials should be used simply in ways that enhance and endorse their intrinsic character.



Solomon R. Guggenheim Museum in New York, Wright, 1943–59